

Jason Coelho

Visual Merchandising Leader | Jordan Brand and Nike | Luxury and Sport Retail

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US Citizen | Cape Town, South Africa | Open to Relocation

Portfolio: parallelstudio.africa/portfolio | Password: portfolio86

PROFILE

Visual merchandising leader with over a decade of experience developing and executing VM strategies, presentation standards and brand experiences across luxury and contemporary fashion brands in the United States. Proven ability to translate global brand direction into compelling consumer experiences at store level, across multi-door retail, wholesale and marketplace environments. Strong background in cross-functional collaboration, team training, planogram development, store openings and commercial performance. Former Nike Pacer with deep product knowledge and authentic connection to sport and running culture.

EXPERIENCE

Regional Visual Merchandising Manager, West Coast

Suitsupply | Los Angeles, CA | August 2023 to May 2025

- Developed and implemented VM presentation standards and seasonal direction across 6 West Coast retail stores.
- Aligned visual merchandising strategy with regional sales objectives and corporate brand strategy.
- Designed and delivered training programmes to upskill 30 plus store staff on VM execution and brand standards.
- Partnered with regional and corporate teams cross-functionally to drive brand consistency across all touchpoints.
- Conducted regular store visits to assess VM execution, identify gaps and implement corrective action.
- Travelled to Amsterdam HQ and Italy for collection styling, seasonal direction and VM alignment.

West Coast Regional Visual Merchandising Manager

Brunello Cucinelli | Los Angeles, CA | September 2019 to March 2022

- Led visual merchandising strategy, presentation standards and seasonal installations across 13 luxury retail boutiques and 25 wholesale accounts including Nordstrom, Saks Fifth Avenue and Neiman Marcus.
- Developed pre-season zoning, store mapping and presentation strategies in partnership with Global VM and Retail Design teams.
- Led 4 new store openings including space planning, fixture coordination, VM build and brand immersion for store teams.
- Designed and delivered VM training programmes and seasonal direction playbooks for store teams across the West Coast network.
- Partnered cross-functionally with brand marketing, merchandising, operations and design teams to deliver seasonal executions.
- Managed new store openings with a focus on consumer experience design during implementation.
- Conducted store visits and VM audits to assess execution quality, identify gaps and implement improvements.
- Travelled to Florence and Milan each season for collection styling, trend alignment and VM direction.

Men's Buyer

Brunello Cucinelli | New York, NY | July 2014 to September 2019

- Managed a \$23M menswear portfolio across 12 US boutiques, achieving 5% profit growth through strategic assortment planning and product optimisation.
- Analysed sales trends across 23 plus locations to improve inventory efficiency, reduce overstock and drive sell-through performance.
- Developed seasonal assortments with end-in-mind consumer and commercial thinking, collaborating with VM teams on product stories and presentation strategies.
- Delivered product knowledge training and seasonal direction to store teams through 20 plus trunk shows annually.

- Supported 5 new store openings including pre-opening product allocation, VM coordination and team training.
- Partnered with VM, marketing, design and operations teams cross-functionally to align commercial and brand priorities.
- Travelled to Brunello Cucinelli HQ in Solomeo, Italy each season for collection previews and product training.

Junior Buyer and Assistant General Manager

Suitsupply | Washington DC and Amsterdam, Netherlands | August 2012 to June 2014

- Promoted twice in under two years, progressing from retail sales to buying training at Amsterdam HQ.
- As Assistant General Manager, managed store operations, team performance and client sales exceeding 1 million USD.
- Supported new store openings in Toronto and Scottsdale including VM execution and product setup.

Nike Pacer and Sales Associate

Nike | New York, NY (Flatiron) | Part-time alongside Brunello Cucinelli

- Nike Pacer and part-time sales associate at the Nike Flatiron store, delivering product knowledge and brand inspiration to consumers and retail associates.
- Assisted on floor sets and VM execution, combining sport passion with retail presentation skills.
- Deep connection to the Nike brand, running culture and athlete-first product philosophy.

CORE SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

- Visual Merchandising Strategy and Direction
- Presentation Standards and Seasonal Playbooks
- Pre-Season Zoning and Store Mapping
- Planogram Development and Retail Lab Sets
- Store Openings and Consumer Experience Design
- Cross-Functional Collaboration (Brand, Merchandising, Design, Operations)
- VM Training and Team Upskilling
- Multi-Door Network Management (Retail, Wholesale, Marketplace)
- Seasonal Campaign and Brand Activation Execution
- Commercial KPI Tracking and Sell-Through Analysis
- Global to Geography VM Direction and Tools
- Fashion Buying and Assortment Planning
- Microsoft Office Suite, Keynote
- Mac Proficient

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Business Administration

University of Johannesburg, South Africa | Focus: Entrepreneurship and Business Communication

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: United States citizen. South African citizen.

Location: Cape Town, South Africa. Open to relocation.

Languages: English (native). Basic Afrikaans.

Interests: Road cycling, running, graphic design.

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